

“The new standard IECQ HSPM 80000 is an ideal approach to adopt system-level compliance”



TÜV Rheinland is a global provider of testing, inspection and certification services. Founded in 1872, it is headquartered in Cologne, Germany, employing more than 16,000 people in 500 locations across 65 countries.

Shanmuga Sundaram, country head, Material Testing Laboratories, TÜV Rheinland India, spoke to Ashwin Gopinath of EFY about environmental directives and TÜV's role in helping companies to meet them

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What project are you currently working on?

The project DG-HSPM (Hazardous Substance Process Management Standard)—part of our corporate social responsibility activity—is a partnership programme funded by DEG Industrial Bank in Germany. This project aims to help the electrical and electronics equipment manufacturing industry in India comply with a new standard called HSPM or ICQ HSPM QCO 80000.

What are the challenges in working with environmental directives for foreign markets?

Today, if you are looking to enter European market, you need to comply with certain environmental directives. These environmental directives look to safeguard the environment and the people. So all along, we not only concentrate on producing a quality product but also ensuring that it is not unsafe to the people and the environment. In other words, every product you manufacture should be free from certain identified hazardous substances. It should be designed such that even after its life-cycle is over, it is easily recyclable.

This environmental directive is called WEEE (Waste Electrical Electronic Equipment) directive. It clearly indicates RRR (Recovery Recycling Ratios), which is very important. After the usage, the product should be re-cycling friendly and easily dismantled. You should be in a position to recover more material out of that. If material recovery is not possible, you need to have a better energy recovery. After material and energy recovery, the leftovers going for

landfill should not contain any hazardous substance.

So this particular project helps these industries to meet the new environmental directive in Europe, which is called ROHS (Restriction of Hazardous Substance). This particular directive can be identified with a specific European directive number 2002/95/EC.

Please tell us more about ROHS Directive and how your project benefits the companies.

This particular directive talks about restriction of six hazardous substances—lead, mercury, cadmium, hexavalent chromium, polybrominated biphenyl and polybrominated diethyl ethers. At the moment, the directive is applicable only in Europe. India too has introduced an India-specific ROHS regulation known as Indian ROHS. The legislation is in force. So all the electronic component manufacturers in India in certain categories will have to control the hazardous substance level in their products by May 2014 whether they export to Europe or serve the domestic market.

Our idea is to help them meet this new environmental initiative. Our project ensures that they meet this hazardous substance requirement not only on a product level but also at the level of raw materials, intermittent products and process chemicals.

The new standard—IECQ HSPM 80000 or IECQ HSPM QCO 80000—is an ideal approach for the industry to adopt system-level compliance. Our project will help the manufacturers to have a complete know-how of this standard and meet its requirements.